

The Noble Vajrapāṇi's Eight Names Together with the Secret Mantra

Āryavajrapāṇyaṣṭanāma Saguhyamantra · Toh 749 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་ལག་ན་རྫོང་མཚན་བརྒྱུ་པ་གསང་སྒྲུས་དང་བཅས་པ།

Toh 749 in the Kangyur is a short tantric text known in English as "The Noble Vajrapāṇi's Eight Names Together with the Secret Mantra," corresponding to the Tibetan "Phags pa lag na rdo rje'i mtshan brgyad pa gsang sngags dang bcas pa." It belongs to the class of mantra or dhāraṇī literature and centers on the eight names of Vajrapāṇi, the bodhisattva who serves as Lord of Secrets, along with the secret mantra and ritual instructions associated with his veneration. The text takes the form of a teaching in which Vajrapāṇi himself, rising from an assembly before the Buddha, requests permission to reveal an elaborate vidyā rite for the benefit of sentient beings. It was translated into Tibetan at the gateway of the great monastery of Nālandā by the Tibetan translator Gyabrtson Senge, and sits within the broader collection of tantric and dhāraṇī works preserved in the Kangyur.

Translated at the gateway of Nālandā by the Tibetan translator Gyabrtson Senge.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

The Noble Vajrapāṇi's Eight Names Together with the Secret Mantra.

Then the bodhisattva, the great being Vajrapāṇi, rose from within the assembly, bowed with joined palms toward the place where the Blessed One was seated, and addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, for the benefit of sentient beings I wish to teach the great elaborate rite of the supreme vidyā together with its secrets and great mysteries. Blessed One, I request permission to go to the royal palace of the Grove of Willows and there tame sentient beings."

Having spoken thus, the Blessed One declared to Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets: "Vajrapāṇi, that you should teach this great elaborate rite of the supreme vidyā — you are wrathful, you are difficult to rely upon, you are extremely difficult to bear, and you are without the conduct of a noble one. Vajrapāṇi, all the activities of those great elaborate rites of the supreme vidyā that you have spoken must be performed without concealment. Vajrapāṇi, therefore, in order that this vajra lineage and this great elaborate rite of the

supreme vidyā may be accomplished with ease, it shall be proclaimed that whoever hears your eight secret names together with the circle of secret mantras — even one who has committed the five acts of immediate retribution will be purified of those misdeeds; and Vajrapāṇi, you yourself will be seen; and all obstructors and misleaders will be scattered; and eighty-four hundred thousand billion misleaders will be scattered in the ten directions; and whoever hears it, even one who has not lived in celibacy will become as one who has lived in celibacy; and one who has not practiced austerity will become as one who has practiced austerity; and one who has not fasted will become as one who has fasted; and one who is not a monk (śramaṇa) will come to possess the fruit of a monk; and all buddhas and bodhisattvas will act as protectors of that person; and the spiritual attainment of activities will be bestowed."

Then Vajrapāṇi touched the two feet of the Blessed One with his head and addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, what are my eight secret names together with the circle of secret mantras?"

The Blessed One declared: "Vajrapāṇi, listen — I shall explain. They are as follows:

You are the one with elephant ears.

You are endowed with excellent ornaments.

You are the one who utterly subdues.

You are the source of precious jewels.

You are truth itself.

You are endowed with the ornaments of beautiful form.

You are the one possessed of blazing flames.

You are the one with a beautiful body.

When learned ones hear these names of yours, for seven hundred thousand billion ten millions of aeons they will not be born in the hells. And all buddhas and bodhisattvas will be present before them at the time of their death, and will teach them the Dharma. By that Dharma teaching, they will be born among the gods of Tuṣṭita and will dwell together with the great bodhisattvas."

Namo buddhāya. Namo dharmāya. Namaḥ saṃghāya. Namo vajrapāṇiye. Tadyathā: aṭṭe aṭṭe kharatṭe some somā sukhi hiri hiri miri kiri bhiri bisani siddhyantu sarva kāryāṇi sādahaya mantra pada svāhā.

Then the bodhisattva, the great being Vajrapāṇi, spoke these words to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, excellent, excellent! How excellent it is that this

great secret teaching has been declared. Blessed One, it is just so, it is just so. Blessed One, when performing the recitation to accomplish the supreme vidyā mantra, and at the time of the accomplishment practice, one should make offerings and recite the eight names. Having recited them, I will be praised, and with joy I shall grant the accomplishments. Obstructing forces will not arise, and the gods too, rejoicing, will swiftly grant the accomplishments. If one recites them at the time of sleep, one will not see evil dreams. If one recites them one hundred thousand times before a reliquary stūpa that enshrines bodily relics, one will be liberated from all sins. Even one who has committed the five acts of immediate retribution will, in the good aeon, be reborn as a bodhisattva

Translator's Notes

- The passage identifies the setting as the "royal palace of the Grove of Willows" — the Tibetan reads "rgyal po'i pho brang lchang lo can," which refers to the Veṇuvana (Bamboo Grove) palace near Rājagṛha; lchang lo can can mean "willow-bearing" or "bamboo-bearing," and the traditional identification is with Veṇuvana, though the phrasing here is unusual.

The eight names as listed in the Blessed One's reply do not appear as a numbered list in the Tibetan but are given as parallel predicate clauses; they have been rendered as verse lines to match the rhetorical structure of the original.

The phrase translated as "eighty-four hundred thousand billion" renders bye ba khrag khrig brgya stong phrag brgyad cu rtsa bzhi, a standard large number formula in Tibetan Buddhist texts corresponding to 8,400,000,000,000 in decimal terms; the English rendering is approximate and follows convention.

The mantra is transliterated from the Tibetan phonetic transcription of Sanskrit as closely as possible; the original Sanskrit underlying the Tibetan phonetics cannot in every syllable be recovered with certainty.

- The passage ends mid-sentence in the source; the translation reflects this open ending faithfully. The "five acts of immediate retribution" renders རྒྱུ་མཚན་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་, the Sanskrit ānantarya-karman, the five heinous deeds whose karmic result is immediate rebirth in the lowest hell. The phrase རྒྱུ་མཚན་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་, literally "I shall be praised," is spoken by Vajrapāṇi in the first person, indicating that reciting his names redounds to his own glorification, after which he rejoices and grants siddhis; this reading is consistent with the standard commentarial understanding of such passages.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the

Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.